ETH zürich

# CIL Projects 2026

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# CIL Projects

# The project is a core part of CIL

- Project work is mandatory. **Groups of three or four students.** No exceptions.
- Project Start Date: **March 30, 08:00 AM**
- Project Submission deadline (Kaggle+Report): **May 29, 11:59 PM**
- **You need to pass the project to pass CIL!**
- **3 Kaggle competitions** (You can/need to do only one!)

# Project rules

- No additional datasets are allowed. Your model needs to be trained on the data we provide.
- Pre-trained models are allowed as long as they are available publicly.
- No external API calls are allowed, except for downloading publicly available, pre-trained model weights.
- Please note that we will verify your code for plagiarism and for using solutions from previous years.
- Do not attempt dataset identification, i.e., do not try to find the test set and train your model on it. We will check your submissions.

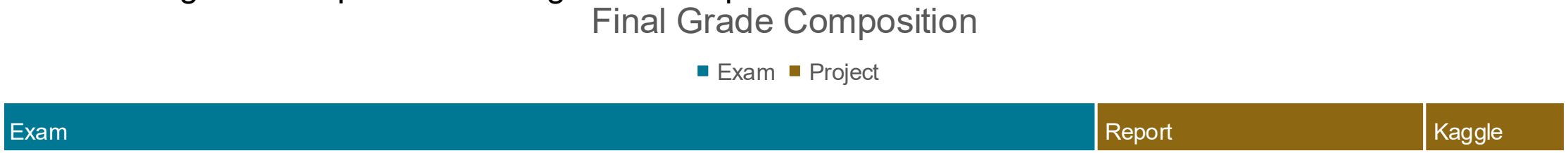
# Working in groups is fundamental experience but …

… there may be problems as CIL is not mandatory for all of you

- Start looking for a group now. Use the Moodle forum!
- Your colleagues could drop out, so…
  - Start with groups of four
  - We may merge groups with less than three students
  - If you have problems or your  workload is fully unbalanced, contact me early

# Project grading is mainly based on your report

- **Project grade = 30% model performance + 70% report and idea quality**
- The model performance is based on your score on Kaggle
  - We will have baselines for grades 4 and 6
  - We will use a private test set
  - Kaggle grade = 4 + 2 * (x- easy_baseline)/(hard_baseline - easy_baseline)
- The report handin consists of 4 written pages + your code
  - Grading is based on
    - Quality of the paper (30%)
    - Creativity of solution (20%)
    - Quality of the implementation (20%)
- You don’t get bonus points for using more compute!



# Computational infrastructure

- You get access to the student cluster after the project registration.
- We allocated 200 GPU hours/student.
- The documentation for the cluster can be found here: https://www.isg.inf.ethz.ch/Main/HelpClusterComputingStudentCluster
- Jobs can be run via Slurm (https://slurm.schedmd.com/quickstart.html) or JupyterHub (https://student-jupyter.inf.ethz.ch).
- The data and a conda environment for each project will be available on the cluster, see Moodle for details.
- Start using your compute early. The cluster is a shared resource and jobs might take a long time to start.